Different water sources for irrigation

Irrigated area



Wells -62%



Canals - 24%



Lakes - 14%

are cultivated in a very low percentage of area. Sorghum(Cholam) cultivation in 7 per cent land area, cumbu in one percent and ragi in 1.7 per cent. Other millets occupy 6 per cent in the year 2014 - 2015.

The area cultivatable land changes every year as a result of many factors such as rainfall, availability of water, weather and market prices.



- River Cauvery is the 3rd largest river in South India. Its length is 765 km.
- The dams constructed across Cauvery in Tamil Nadu are Mettur Dam, Kallanai

4.5 Decadal growth in agricultural production

The total quantity of foodgrains produced in Tamil Nadu in the year 2014 - 2015 was one crore 27 lakh 35 thousand tonnes. Paddy alone accounted to 80 lakhs tonnes. The contribution of paddy to the total amount of food production is 62%. Maize production was 20%, corn 7%, ragi 3% and another 3% occupied by black gram, while other food crops contributed a very meager amount to the total food production in Tamil Nadu.

The amount of production varies depending on the amount of land being cultivated.

4.6 The yield of productive crops

The amount of production depends not only on the area but also on the productivity of crops.

Production capacity of paddy in Tamil Nadu was 4,429 kg per hectare in 2014-2015. This capacity was 3,039 kilograms in 2010-2011 revealing the increase in productivity.

Next to paddy, maize stands second in the production (8,824 kg/hectare).

2,093 kg/hectare corn, 3,077 kgs of rye (cumbu) and 3348 kgs of ragi were produced during the same period.

Black gram, one of the largest cultivated pulses, produced 645 kg per hectare. Production of sugarcane and ground nut (Manila) were 107 tons and 2,753 kg per hectare respectively.

The productivity of crops continues to increase. For example the productivity of paddy in 1965 - 66 was 1,409 kg. It increased to 2,029 kg in 1975-76 and 2,372 kg in 1985-86. It increased to 2,712 kg after a decade. The production was 4,429 kg in the year 2014-15. In the past fifty years, the



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